

Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

Impress Guide

AOO Documentation Team

Chapter **11**

Setting Up and Customizing Impress

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Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

<i>Windows/Linux</i>	<i>Mac equivalent</i>	<i>Effect</i>
Tools > Options menu selection	OpenOffice > Preferences	Access setup options
<i>Right-click</i>	<i>Control+click</i>	Open context menu
<i>Ctrl</i> (Control)	⌘ (Command)	Used with other keys
<i>F5</i>	<i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>	Open the Navigator
<i>F11</i>	<i>⌘+T</i>	Open Styles & Formatting window

Contents

Chapter 11

Setting Up and Customizing Impress	1
Choosing Options That Affect All of AOO	4
User Data Options	4
Print Options	4
Color Options	5
Appearance Options	5
Choosing Options for Impress	6
General Options	6
View Options	8
Grid Options	8
Print Options	10
Customizing the User Interface	11
Customizing the Menu Font	11
Customizing Menu Content	11
Customizing Toolbars	14
Customizing Keyboard Shortcuts	17
Adding Functionality with Extensions	19
Installing Extensions	19

Choosing Options That Affect All of AOO

This section covers some of the settings that apply to all components of OpenOffice, and are of most interest to users of Impress. Other general options are discussed in Chapter 2 (Setting Up OpenOffice) in the *Getting Started* guide.

- 1) Click **Tools > Options (OpenOffice > Preferences** on a Mac). The list on the left-hand side of the Options – OpenOffice dialog varies depending on which component of AOO is open. The illustrations in this chapter show the list as it appears when Impress is open.
- 2) Click the expansion marker (+ or triangle) by *OpenOffice* on the left-hand side. A list of subsections drops down (Figure 1).

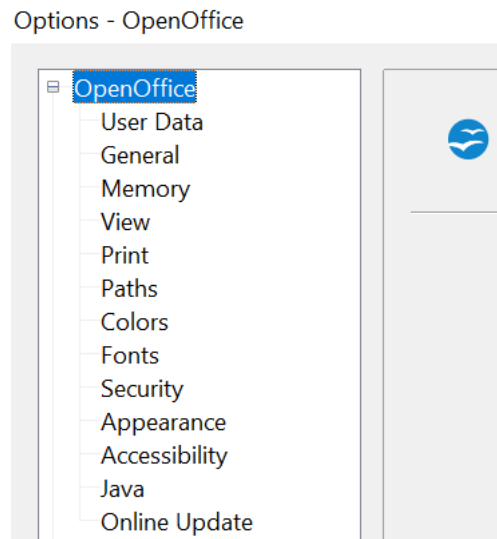


Figure 1: OpenOffice options

Note

The **Back** button has the same effect on all pages of the Options dialog. It resets the options to the values that were in place when you opened OpenOffice.

User Data Options

Impress uses the first and last name stored in the User Data page to fill in the *Created by* and *Modified by* fields in the document properties, the optional *Author* field often in the footer of a presentation, and the name associated with comments. You will want to ensure that your name appears there. To do this:

- 1) In the Options dialog, click **OpenOffice > User Data**.
- 2) Fill in the form or delete any existing incorrect information.

Print Options

On the OpenOffice – Print page, set the print options to be compatible with your default printer and your most frequently used printing method.

You can change these settings at any time, either through the Options dialog or during the printing process (by clicking the **Options** button on the Print dialog).

See Chapter 10 (Printing, e-mailing, exporting, and saving slide shows) for more about the options on this page.

Color Options

On the OpenOffice – Colors page (Figure 2), you can specify colors to use in AOO documents. You can select a color from a color table, edit an existing color, and define new colors. These colors are stored in your color selection palette and are then available in all components of AOO. You can also define colors within Impress by choosing **Format > Area** on the menu bar, or through the Line and Filling toolbar, but those colors will not be available to other components of AOO.

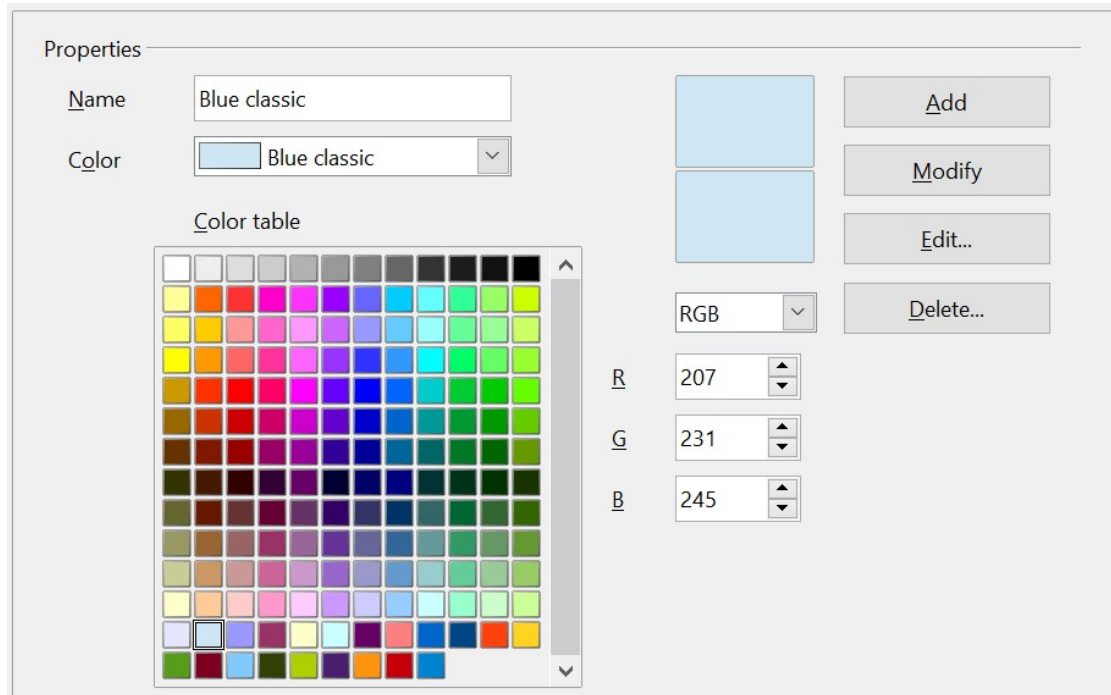


Figure 2. Defining colors to use in color palettes in AOO

Appearance Options

On the OpenOffice – Appearance page, you can specify which items are visible, as well as the colors used to display various elements of the user interface.

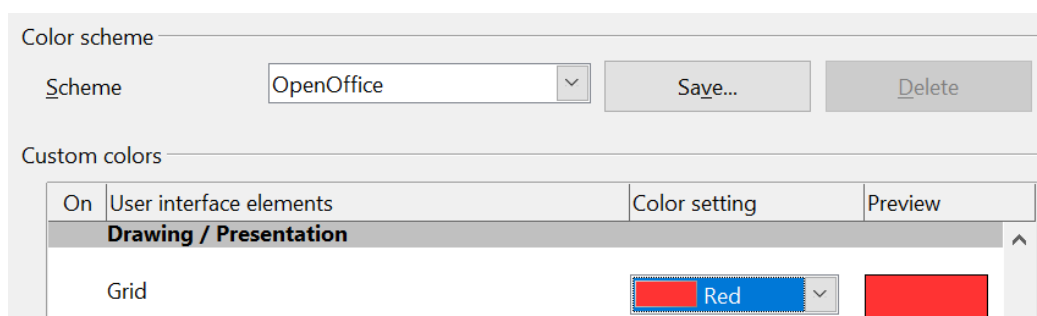


Figure 3. Changing the color of grid points in Impress and Draw

The only choice specific to Impress (and Draw) is the color of the grid points. Scroll down in the page until you find **Drawing/Presentation**.

To change the default color for grid points, click the down arrow by the color and select a new color from the pop-up box.

If you wish to save your color changes as a color scheme, click **Save**, type a name in the *Scheme* box, and click **OK**.

Choosing Options for Impress

In the Options dialog, click the expansion marker to the left of *OpenOffice Impress* on the left-hand side as shown in Figure 4. A list of subsections drops down.

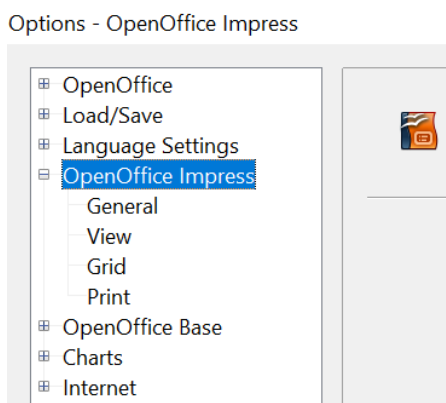


Figure 4: Options for Impress

General Options

In the Options dialog, click **OpenOffice Impress > General** (Figure 5).

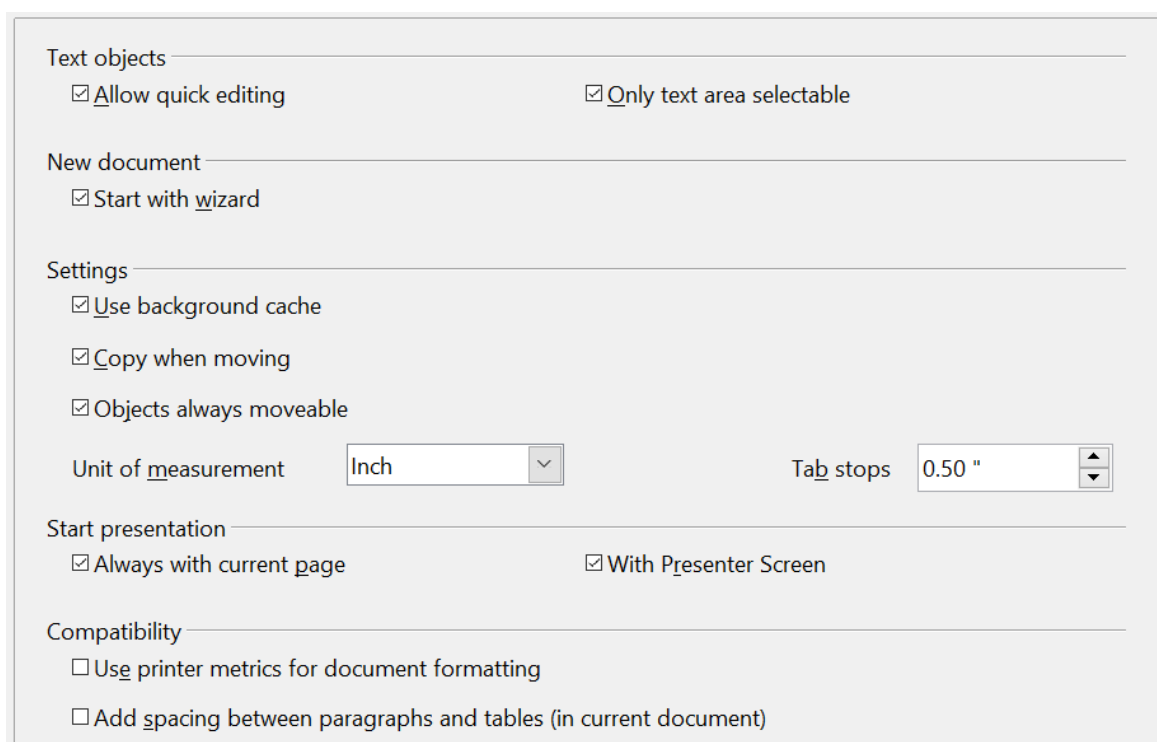


Figure 5: Specifying general options for Impress

Text Objects Section

Allow quick editing sets Impress to switch immediately to text editing mode when you click a text object. You can also activate the text editing mode through the **Allow**

Quick Editing icon  on the Options toolbar.

Only text area selectable sets Impress to select a text frame when you click on text. In the area of the text frame that is not filled with text, an object behind the text frame can be selected. You can also activate this mode through the **Select Text Area**

Only icon  on the Options toolbar.

New Document Section

Start with Wizard sets Impress to start the Presentation Wizard when creating a new presentation using **File > New > Presentation** or other methods.

Settings Section

Use background cache sets Impress to use the cache for displaying objects on the master page. This setting speeds up the display. Uncheck this box if you want Impress to draw the background every time you display a slide.

Copy when moving automatically creates a copy when you move, rotate, or resize an object while holding down the *Ctrl* key (⌘ key for Mac). The original object will remain in its current position and size.

Objects always movable lets you move an object with the **Rotate** tool enabled. If this box is not checked, the **Rotate** tool can only be used to rotate an object.

Unit of measurement determines the unit of measurement for presentations.

Tab stops defines the spacing between tab stops.

Start Presentation Section

Always with current page specifies that a presentation starts with the current slide. Unmark this box to always start a presentation with the first page.

With Presenter Screen activates a window with extra information for the presenter during a slide show if the slide show is displayed on a second screen or an external device. See Chapter 9 Slide Shows for more information.

Compatibility Section

The settings in this area are valid for the current document only.

Use printer metrics for document formatting applies printer metrics for both printing and formatting the display on the screen. Some formatting will depend on the printer selection or the default printer on your computer, and may vary if the presentation is moved to a different computer. If this box is not checked, a printer-independent layout is used for screen display and printing.

Add spacing between paragraphs (in current document) calculates the paragraph spacing in Impress exactly as Microsoft PowerPoint does. Microsoft PowerPoint calculates the total spacing between paragraphs by adding the bottom spacing of one paragraph with the top spacing of the next. Impress normally uses only the larger of the two spacings.

View Options

In the Options dialog, click **OpenOffice Impress > View** (Figure 6).

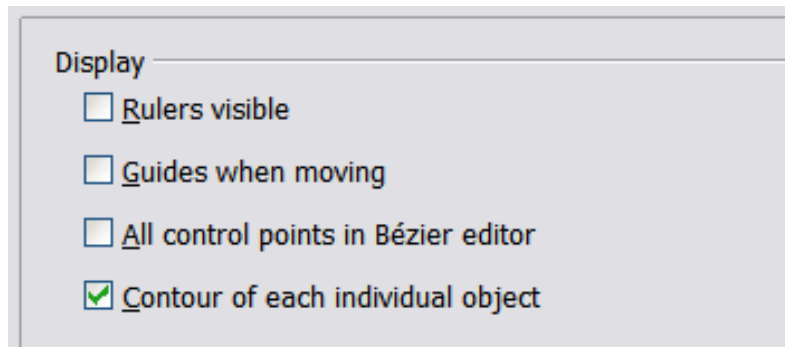


Figure 6: Specifying view options for Impress

Rulers visible displays the rulers at the top and the left of the work area.

Guides when moving displays dotted guides that extend beyond the box containing the selected object and cover the entire work area, helping you position the object

when moving it. You can also use the **Guides when moving** icon  on the Options toolbar.

All control points in Bézier editor displays the control points of all Bézier points if you have previously selected a Bézier curve. If this box is not marked, only the control points of the selected Bézier points will be visible.

Note

A Bézier curve is a mathematical curve defined by a set of control points that guide its shape. It is a parametric function used in computer graphics, design, and animation to create smooth, scalable, and precise shapes. The curve starts at the first control point and ends at the last, while the intermediate control points "pull" the curve towards them to determine its path

Contour of each individual object displays the contour line of the object when it is moved. This enables you to see if single objects conflict with other objects in the target position. If you do not mark this box, Impress displays only a square contour that includes all selected objects.

Grid Options

The Grid page defines the grid settings for Impress. Using a grid helps you determine the exact position of your objects. You can also set this grid in line with the snap grid.

To open the Options dialog shown in Figure 7, click **OpenOffice Impress > Grid**.

Grid Section

Snap to grid activates the "snap" function.

If you have activated the snap grid but wish to move or create individual objects without snap positions, you can press the *Ctrl* key to deactivate the snap grid for as long as needed.

Visible grid displays grid points on the screen. These points will not display or print as part of a presentation.

Resolution Section

Here you can set the unit of distance for the spacing between horizontal and vertical grid points and subdivisions (intermediate points) of the grid.

Synchronize axes applies any changes to the Resolution or Subdivision settings to both axes.

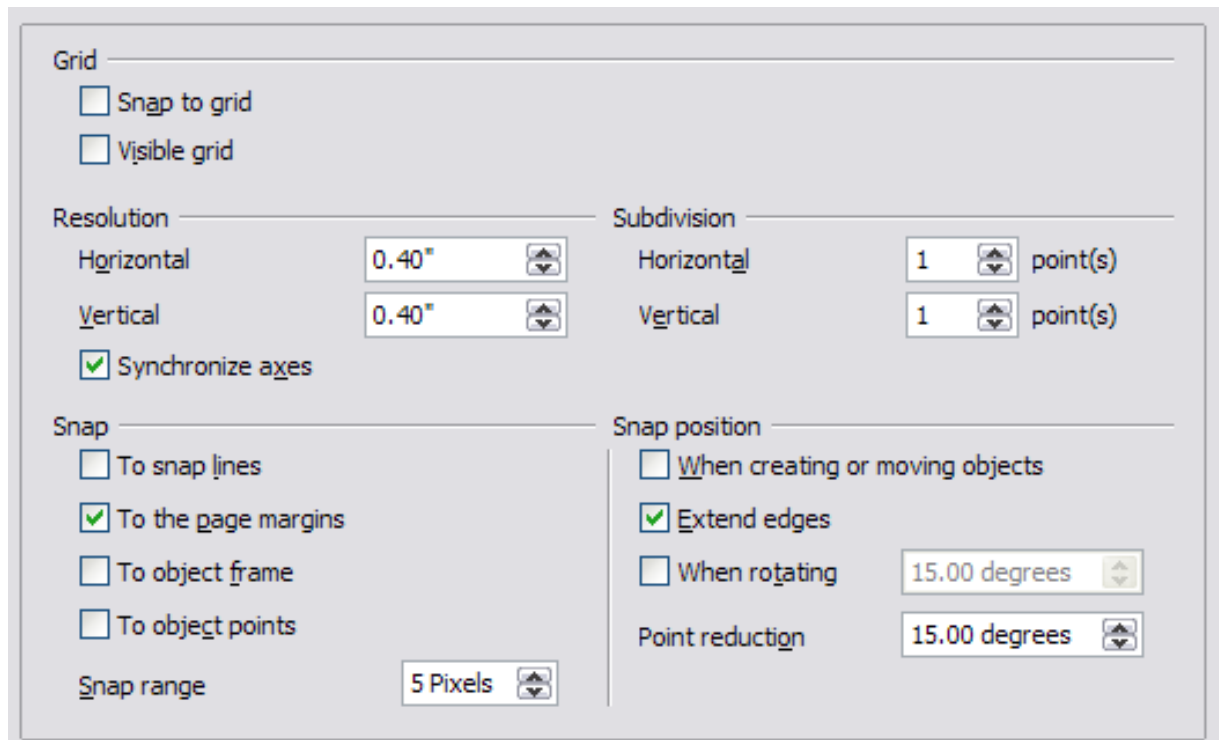


Figure 7: Specifying grid options for Impress

Snap Section

A graphic object will be snapped (aligned with an existing reference point) if it is dragged within snap range of that point. Whether the distance is measured from the mouse pointer or from the edge of the object depends on the setting of *Contour of each individual object* in the *View options* page.

To snap lines snaps the edge of a dragged object to the nearest snap line when you release the mouse button. You can also use the **Snap to Guides** icon  on the Options toolbar.

To the page margins aligns the contour of the graphic object with the nearest page margin. You can also use the **Snap to Page Margins** icon  on the Options toolbar.

To object frame aligns the contour of the graphic object to the border of the nearest graphic object. You can also use the **Snap to Object Border** icon  on the Options toolbar.

To object points aligns the contour of the graphic object to the points of the nearest graphic object. You can also use the **Snap to Object Points** icon  on the Options toolbar.

Snap range defines the distance within which snapping occurs. Impress snaps to a snap point only if the mouse pointer (or the object contour) is nearer to that point than the distance selected in the **Snap range** box.

Snap Position Section

When creating or moving objects restricts graphic objects vertically, horizontally, or diagonally (45°) during these actions. You can temporarily deactivate this setting by pressing the *Shift* key.

Extend edges controls how a square or circle is drawn with the drawing tool. When the **Extend edges** box is marked, the sides of the square created when the *Shift* key is pressed before you release the mouse button will be equal to the longer side of the rectangle you have actually drawn. This also applies to the ellipse tool: when the *Shift* key is pressed before you release the mouse button, a circle will be created based on the longest diameter of the ellipse. When the **Extend edges** box is not marked, a square or a circle will be created based on the shorter side or diameter.

When rotating restricts the rotation of graphic objects within the rotation angle that you select in the **When rotating** box. If you want to rotate an object outside of the defined angle, press the *Ctrl* key (*Shift* key on Mac) when rotating. Release the key when the desired rotation angle is reached.

Point reduction defines the angle for point reduction. When working with polygons, you might find it useful to reduce the number of editing points to make it easier to snap to a desired point.

Print Options

To open the Options dialog shown in Figure 8, click **OpenOffice Impress > Print**.

See Chapter 10 (Printing, e-mailing, exporting, and saving slide shows) for more about the options on this page.

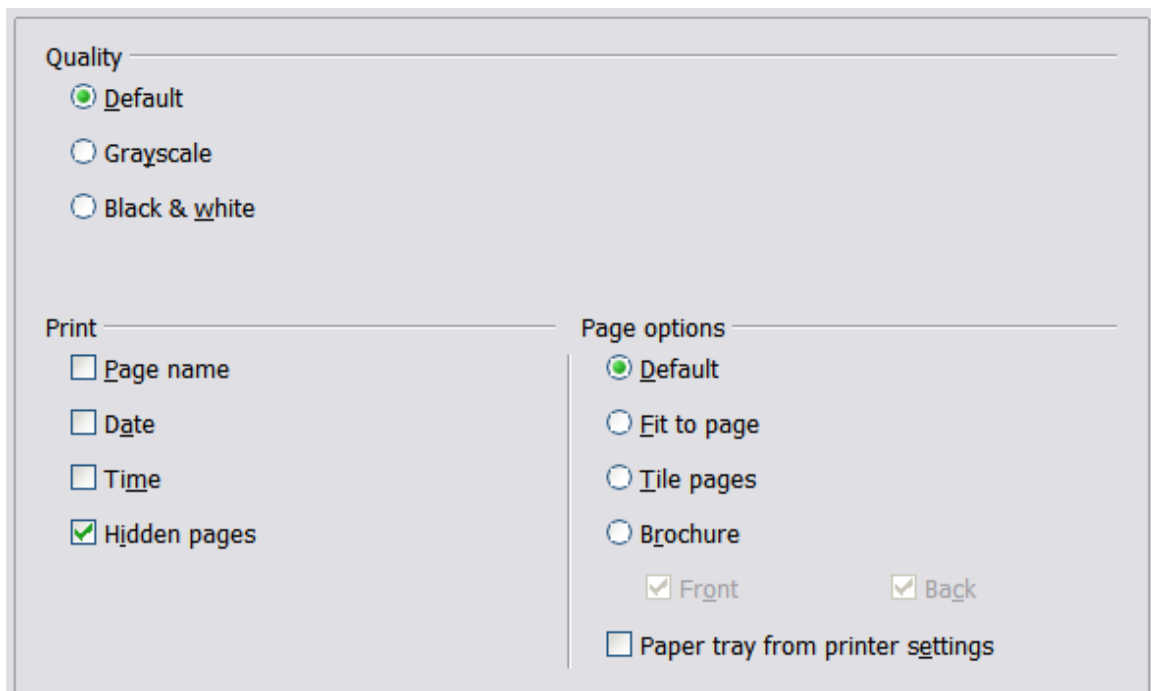


Figure 8: Specifying print options for Impress

Customizing the User Interface

Customizing the Menu Font

If you want to change the menu font from that supplied by AOO to the system font for your operating system, do this:

- 1) Choose **Tools > Options > OpenOffice > View**.
- 2) Check **Use system font for user interface** and click **OK**.

Customizing Menu Content

You can customize menus: add and rearrange items on the menu bar, add items to menus, and make other changes.

- 1) Choose **Tools > Customize**.
- 2) On the Customize dialog, pick the **Menus** tab (Figure 9).

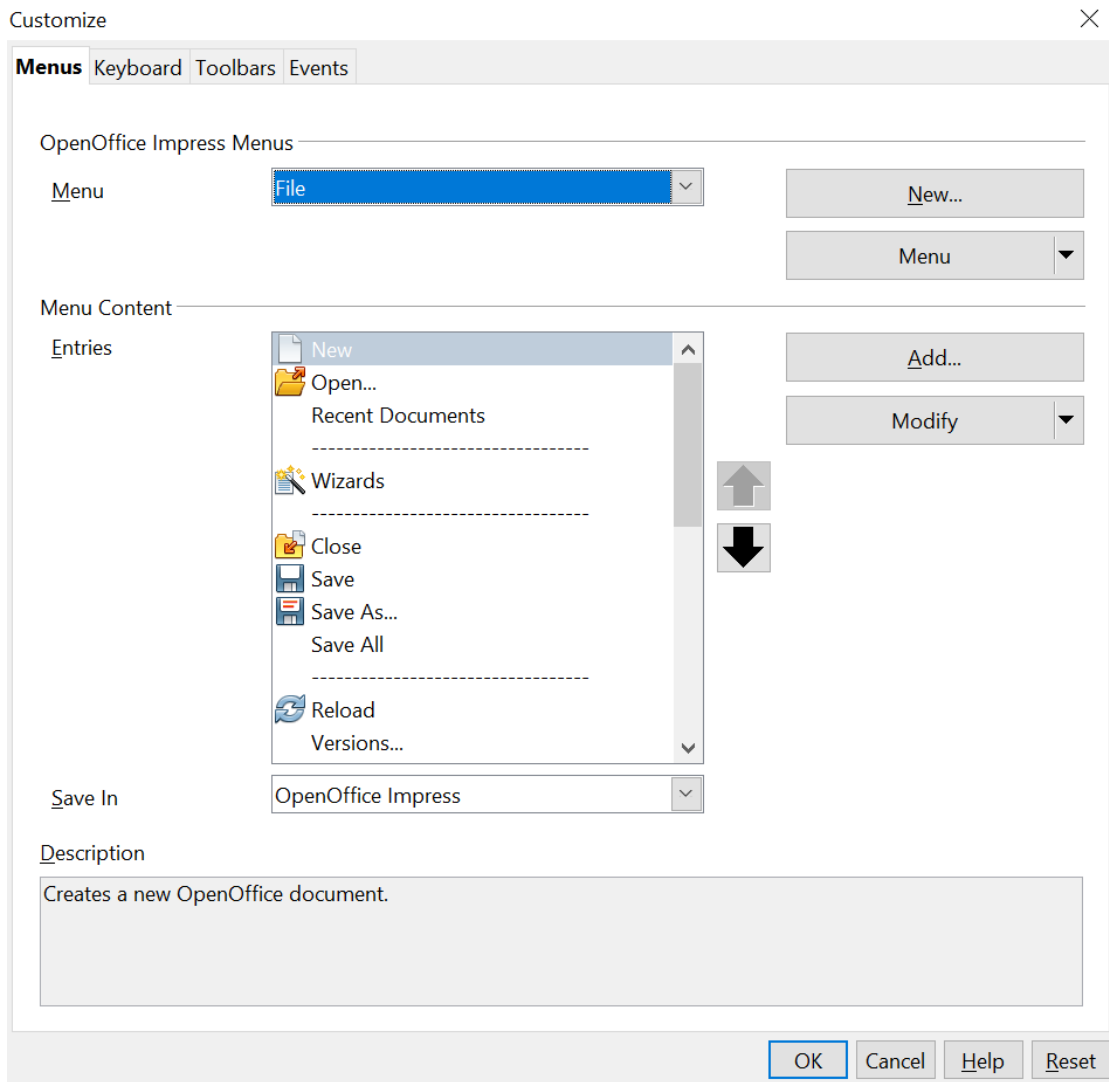


Figure 9. The Menus tab of the Customize dialog

- 3) In the **Save In** drop-down list, choose whether to save this changed menu for Impress or for a selected document (for example, MySlideShow.odp).
- 4) In the section **OpenOffice Impress Menus**, select the menu you want to customize from the **Menu** drop-down list.
- 5) To customize the selected menu, click on the **Menu** or **Modify** buttons. You can also add commands to a menu by clicking on the **Add** button. These actions are described in the following sections. Use the up and down arrows next to the Entries list to move the selected menu item to a different position.
- 6) When you have finished making all your changes, click **OK** to save them.

Creating a New Menu

In the Menus tab of the Customize dialog, click **New** to display the dialog shown in Figure 10.

- 1) Type a name for your new menu in the **Menu name** box.
- 2) Use the up and down arrow buttons to move the new menu into the required position on the menu bar.
- 3) Click **OK** to save.

The new menu now appears on the list of menus in the Customize dialog. (It will appear on the menu bar itself after you save your customizations.)

After creating a new menu, you need to add some commands to it, as described in “Adding a Command to a Menu” on page 14.

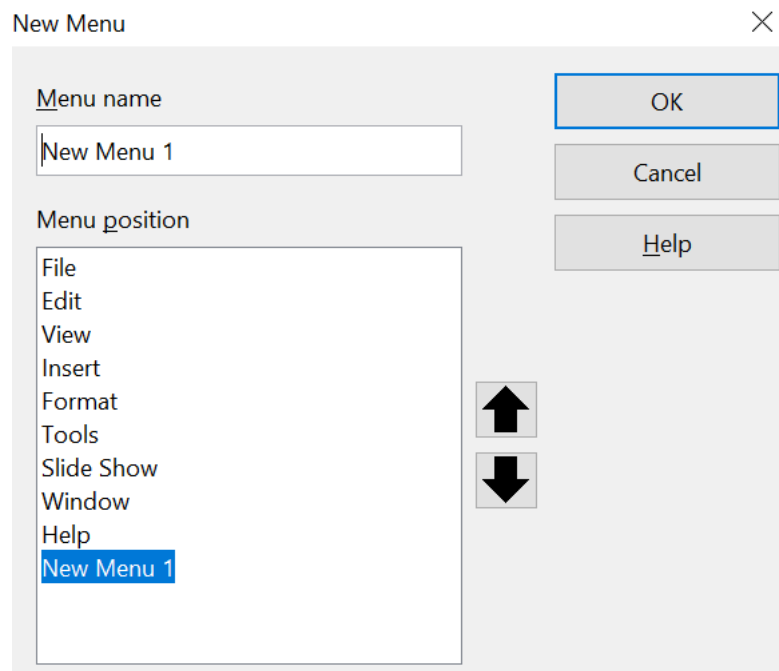


Figure 10: Adding a new menu

Modifying Existing Menus

To modify an existing menu, select it in the Menu list and click the **Menu** button to drop down a list of modifications: **Move**, **Rename**, and **Delete**. Not all of these modifications can be applied to all the entries in the Menu list. For example, **Rename** and **Delete** are not available for the menus supplied by AOO.

To move a menu (such as *File*), choose **Menu > Move**. A dialog similar to the one shown in Figure 10 (but without the **Menu name** box) opens. Use the up and down arrow buttons to move the menu into the required position.

To move submenus (such as *File | Send*), select the main menu (File) in the Menu list and then, in the Menu Content section of the dialog, select the submenu (Send) in the Entries list and use the arrow keys to move it up or down in the sequence. Submenus are easily identified in the Entries list by a small black triangle on the right side of the name.

In addition to renaming, you can specify a keyboard shortcut that allows you to select a menu command when you press *Alt*+ an underlined letter in a menu command.

- 1) Select a menu or menu entry.
- 2) Click the **Modify** button and select **Rename**.
- 3) Add a tilde (~) in front of the letter that you want to use as an accelerator. For example, to select the Save All command by pressing *Alt*+*V* (after opening the File menu using *Alt*+*F*), enter *Sa~ve All*.

Caution



Be careful when using these shortcuts. In the example above, if the File menu is not already open, pressing *Alt*+*V* opens the View menu. However, if another menu is open, *Alt*+*V* might activate a different command.

Adding a Command to a Menu

You can add commands to the supplied menus and to menus you have created. In the Customize dialog, select the menu in the Menu list and click the **Add** button in the Menu Content section of the dialog.

On the Add Commands dialog (Figure 11), select a category, choose the command, and click **Add**. The dialog remains open, so that you can select additional commands. When you have finished adding commands, click **Close**. Back in the Customize dialog, you can use the up and down arrow buttons to arrange the commands in your preferred sequence.

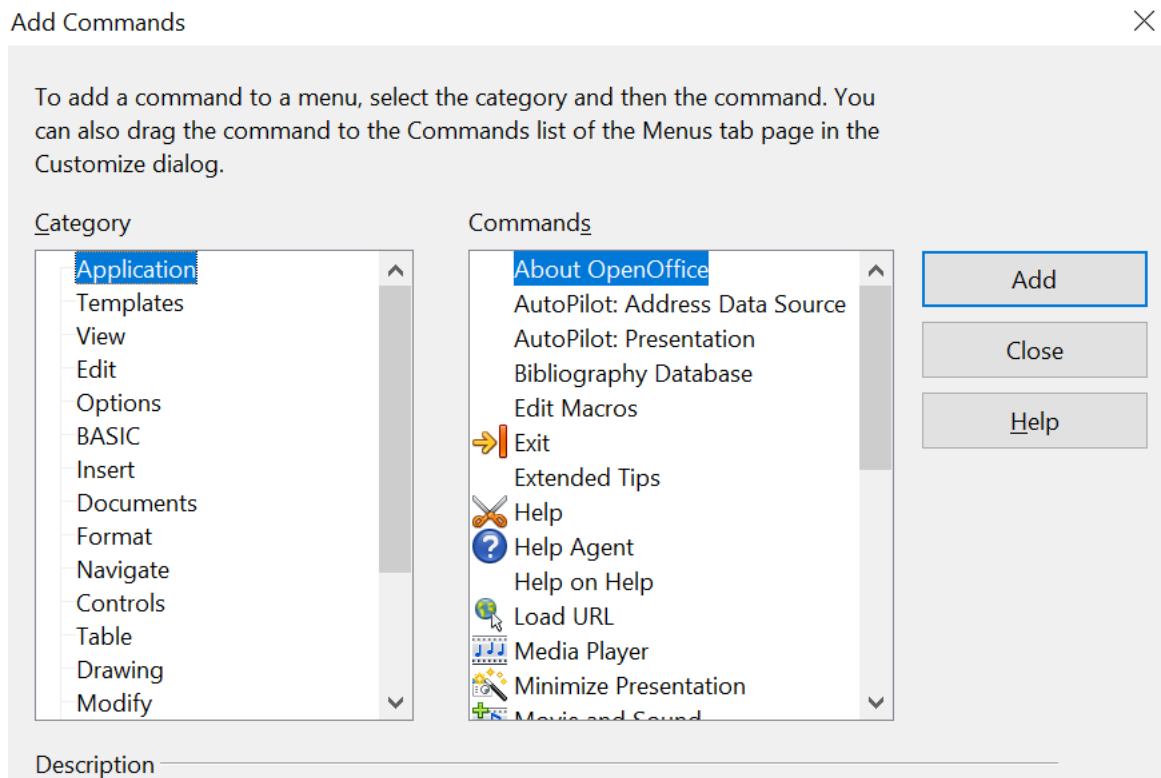


Figure 11: Adding a command to a menu

Modifying Menu Entries

In addition to changing the sequence of entries on a menu or submenu, you can add submenus, rename or delete the entries, and add group separators.

To begin, select the menu or submenu in the Menu list near the top of the Customize tab, then select the entry in the Entries list under Menu Content. Click the **Modify** button and choose the required action from the drop-down list. Most of the actions should be self-explanatory. **Begin a group** adds a separator line after the highlighted entry.

Customizing Toolbars

You can customize toolbars in several ways, including choosing which icons are visible and locking the position of a docked toolbar, as described in Chapter 1 (Introducing OpenOffice) of the *Getting Started* guide. This section describes how to create new toolbars and add other icons, that is, commands, to the list of those available on a toolbar.

To get to the toolbar customization dialog (Figure 12), do any of the following:

- On the toolbar, click the arrow at the end of the toolbar and choose **Customize Toolbar**.
- Choose **View > Toolbars > Customize** from the menu bar.
- Choose **Tools > Customize > Toolbars** tab from the menu bar.

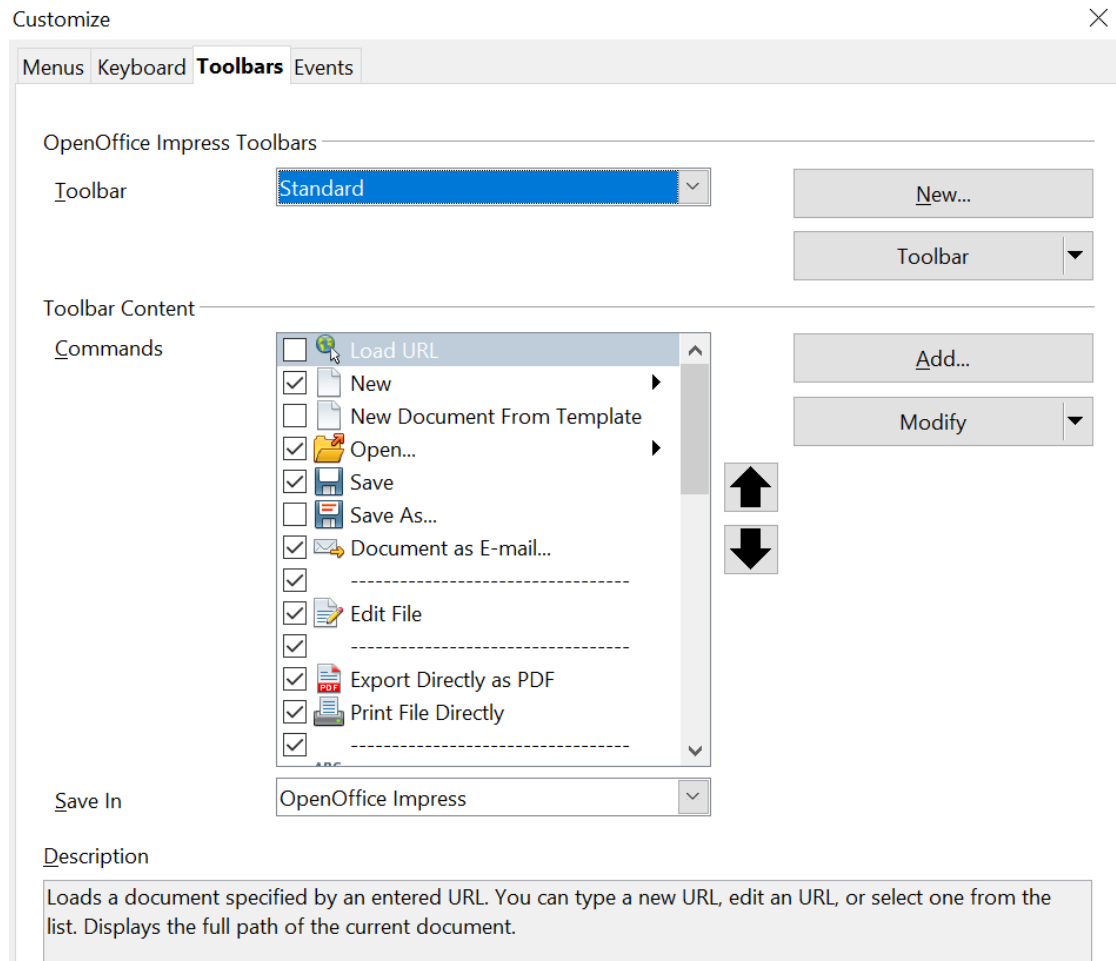


Figure 12. The Toolbars tab of the Customize window

To customize toolbars:

- 1) In the Save In drop-down list, choose whether to save this changed toolbar for Impress or for a selected document.
- 2) In the OpenOffice Impress Toolbars section, select the toolbar that you want to customize from the Toolbar drop-down list.
- 3) Click the Toolbar button on the right to display a drop-down list of choices.
- 4) To display or hide commands, select or deselect the check boxes in the Toolbar Content – Commands section.
- 5) To change the hierarchical position of commands on a toolbar, select a command and then click the up arrow to move the command higher in the list, or the down arrow to move the command to a lower spot in the hierarchy. Both arrows are to the right of the lists.
- 6) You can create a new toolbar by clicking on the New button, or customize existing toolbars by clicking on the Toolbar or Modify buttons, and add commands to a toolbar by clicking on the Add button. These actions are described below.

- 7) When finished customizing toolbars, click **OK** to save your changes.

Creating a New Toolbar

To create a new toolbar:

- 1) Choose **Tools > Customize > Toolbars** from the menu bar.
- 2) Click **New**. In the Name dialog (Figure 13), type the new toolbar's name and, from the Save In drop-down list, choose where to save the changed menu.

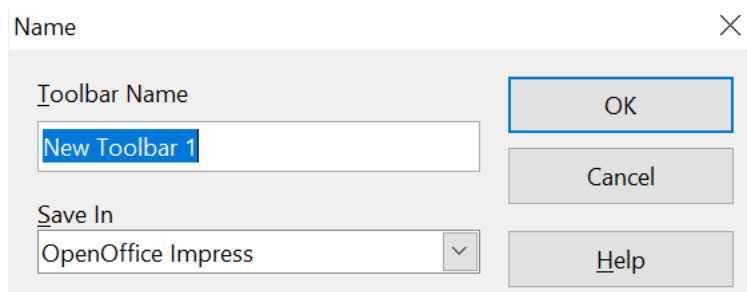


Figure 13: Dialog used to create a new toolbar

The new toolbar now appears on the list of toolbars in the Customize dialog. After creating a new toolbar, you need to add some commands to it, as described below.

Adding a Command to a Toolbar

If the list of available buttons for a toolbar does not include all the commands you want on that toolbar, you can add commands.

- 1) On the Toolbars tab of the Customize dialog, select the toolbar in the Toolbar list and click the **Add** button in the Toolbar Content section of the dialog.
- 2) The Add Commands dialog is the same as the one used for adding commands to menus. Select a category, choose the command, and click **Add**. The dialog remains open, so you can select additional commands. When you have finished adding commands, click **Close**. If you insert an item that does not have an associated icon, the toolbar will display the full name of the item; the next section describes how to choose an icon for a toolbar command.
- 3) Back on the Customize dialog, you can use the up and down arrow buttons to arrange the commands in your preferred sequence.
- 4) When you are done making changes, click **OK** to save.

Choosing Icons for Toolbar Commands

Toolbar buttons usually have icons, not words, on them, but not all commands have associated icons.

To choose an icon for a command, select the command and click **Modify > Change icon**. On the Change Icon dialog (Figure 14), you can scroll through the available icons, select one, and click **OK** to assign it to the command.

To use a custom icon, create it in a graphics program and import it into AOO by clicking the **Import** button on the Change Icon dialog. Custom icons must be 16 x 16 or 26 x 26 pixels in size and cannot contain more than 256 colors.

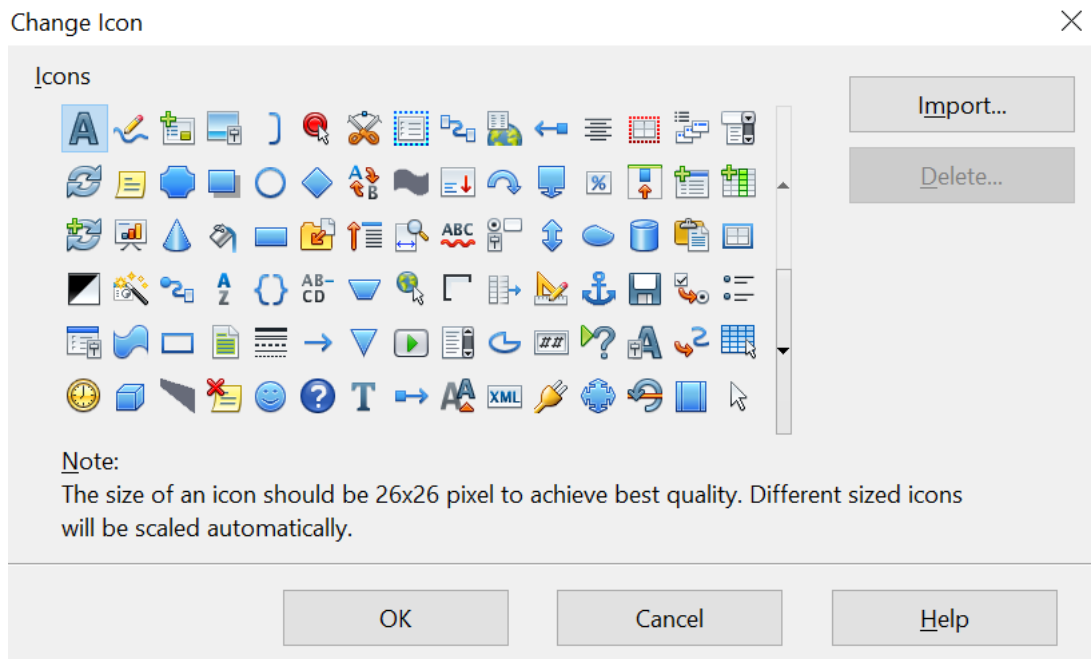


Figure 14: Change Icon dialog

Customizing Keyboard Shortcuts

The Appendix to this book lists the default keyboard shortcuts supplied with Impress. You can change these defaults or add new shortcuts. You can assign shortcuts to standard Impress functions or your own macros and save them for use with Impress only, or with the entire OpenOffice suite.

Caution



Be careful when reassigning your operating system's or AOO's predefined shortcut keys. Many key assignments are universally understood shortcuts, such as *F1* for Help, and are always expected to provide certain results. Although you can easily reset the shortcut key assignments to the defaults, changing some common shortcut keys can cause confusion, frustration, and possible data loss or corruption, especially if other users share your computer.

As an example, suppose you wish to assign a shortcut key to insert a duplicate slide in your presentation easily. You could assign the *Insert* key as a logical shortcut for this purpose, as described below:

- 1) Choose **Tools > Customize**.
- 2) On the Customize dialog, pick the Keyboard tab (Figure 15).
- 3) As the shortcut key assignment is only relevant with Impress, and not OpenOffice in general, select the **Impress** button (at the upper right corner of the **Keyboard** tab).

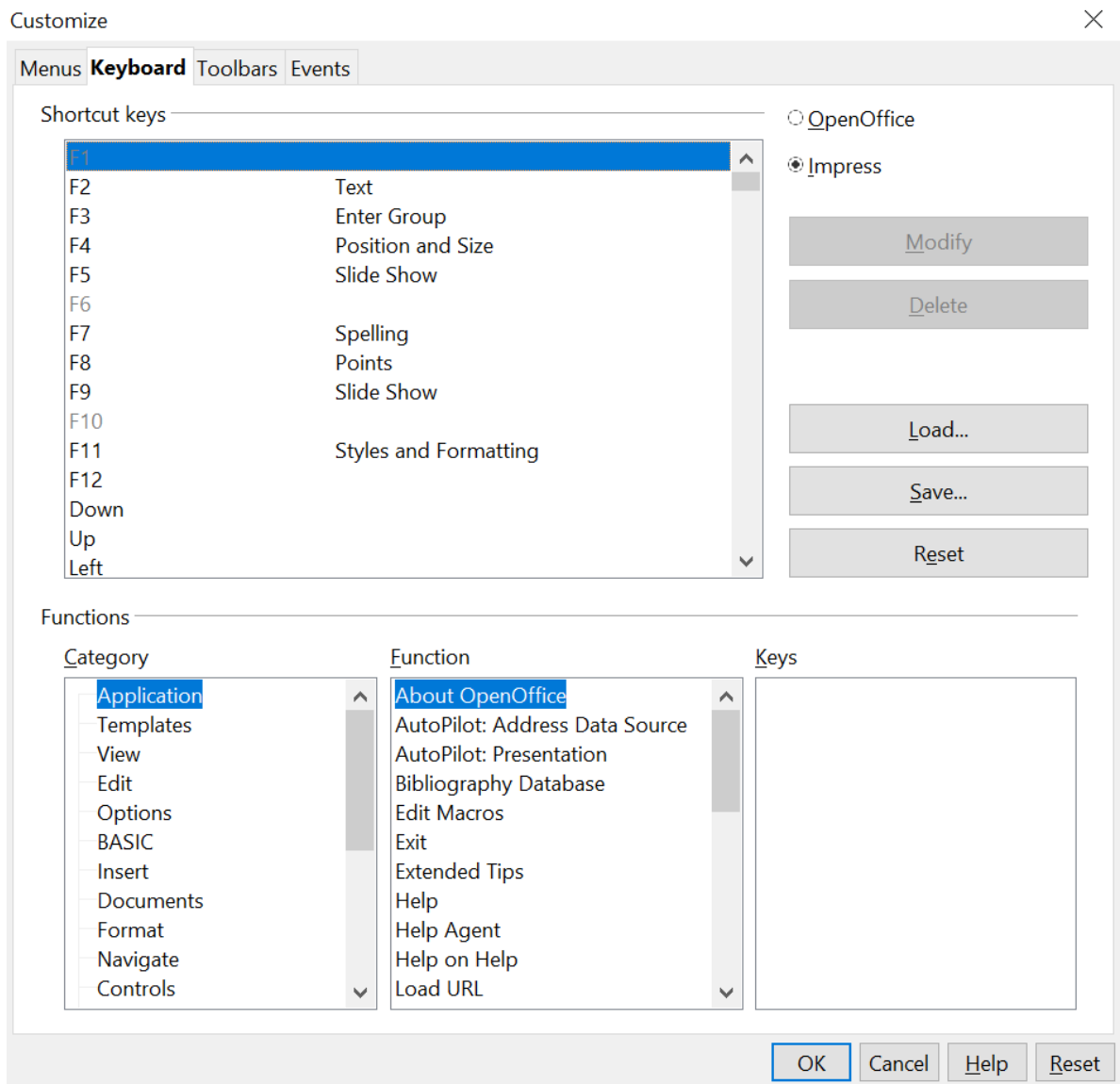


Figure 15: Customizing keyboard shortcuts

- 4) Next, select **Insert** in the *Category* list and **Duplicate Slide** in the *Function* list.
- 5) Now select the shortcut key *Insert* in the *Shortcut keys* list and click the **Modify** button at the upper right.
- 6) Click **OK** to accept the change. Now the *Insert* shortcut key will insert a duplicate slide immediately after the currently selected slide.

Note

All existing shortcut keys for the currently selected *Function* are listed in the *Keys* selection box. Since there was no currently assigned shortcut for the **Insert > Duplicate Slide** function, the *Keys* list was empty. If it had not been, and you wished to reassign a shortcut key combination that was already in use, you would first have had to **Delete** the existing *Key*.

Shortcut keys that are greyed out in the Customize dialog listing, such as *F1* and *F10*, are not available for reassignment.

Saving Changes to a File

Changes to the shortcut key assignments (and other configurations) can be saved in a keyboard configuration file for use at a later time, thus permitting you to create and apply different configurations as the need arises. To save keyboard shortcuts to a file:

- 1) After making your keyboard shortcut assignments, click the **Save** button near the bottom right of the Customize dialog.
- 2) In the Save Keyboard Configuration dialog, select *All files* from the **Save as Type** list.
- 3) Next, enter a name for the keyboard configuration file in the **File name** box, or select an existing file from the list. If you need to, browse to find a file from another location.
- 4) Click **Save**. A confirmation dialog will appear if you are about to overwrite an existing file; otherwise, there will be no feedback, and the file will be saved.

Loading a Saved Keyboard Configuration

To load a saved keyboard configuration file and replace your existing configuration, click the **Load** button near the bottom right of the Customize dialog, and then select the configuration file from the Load Keyboard Configuration dialog.

Resetting the Shortcut Keys

To reset all of the keyboard shortcuts to their default values, click the **Reset** button beneath the **Save** button on the right side of the Customize dialog. Use this feature with care, as no confirmation dialog will be displayed; the defaults will be set without any further notice or user input.

Running Macros from Key Combinations

You can also define shortcut key combinations that will run macros. These shortcut keys are strictly user-defined; none are built in. For information on macros, see Chapter 13 (Getting started with macros) in the *Getting Started* guide.

Adding Functionality with Extensions

An extension is a package that can be added to your existing OpenOffice configuration to offer new functionality.

Although individual extensions can be found in different places, the official OpenOffice extension repository is at <https://extensions.services.openoffice.org/>. Some extensions are free of charge; others are available for a fee. Check the descriptions to see what licenses and fees apply to the ones that interest you.

Installing Extensions

To install an extension, follow these steps:

- 1) Download an extension and save it anywhere on your computer.
- 2) In AOO, select **Tools > Extension Manager** from the menu bar. In the Extension Manager dialog (Figure 16), click **Add**.
- 3) A file browser window opens. Find and select the extension you want to install and click **Open**. The extension begins installing. You may be asked to accept a license agreement.
- 4) When the installation is complete, the extension is listed in the Extension Manager dialog.

Tip

To get extensions that are listed in the repository, you can open the Extension Manager and click the **Get more extensions online** link.

Note

To install a *shared* extension, you need write access to the OpenOffice installation directory.

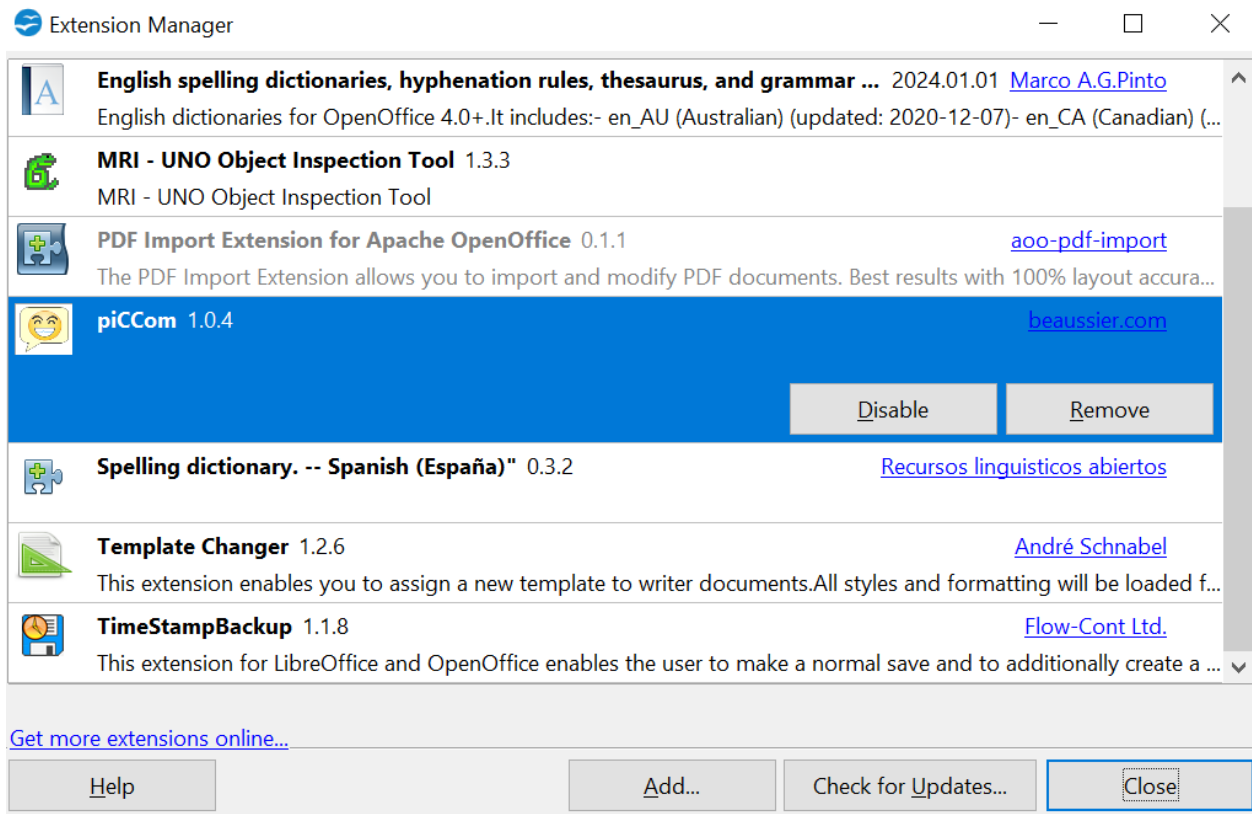


Figure 16: The Extension Manager